Open Specifications Still to Lock Before Implementation

Developer addendum. This document captures the remaining product specifications that should be fixed before implementation starts in full. It does not change scope. It translates the agreed direction into concrete system decisions.

Status	**What is still open**
The overall product vision, three-layer model, intake logic, participant logic, preview logic, approvals, and MVP cut are already defined.	The remaining work is not a new concept. It is the hard specification layer required to build the product consistently.

1. Binding object model

The system already references many objects, but the implementation still needs one final binding object model for Phase 1. This should define which entities are truly first-class and how they relate to each other.

The following object set should now be locked explicitly for Phase 1:

- Project

- Project Version

- Structured Project Description

- Approved Resource

- Document

- Participant

- Approval

- Cost Group

- Cost Item

- Package

- Tender Release State

For each object, the implementation still needs:

- mandatory fields

- optional fields

- parent and child relationships

- whether the object can be created automatically or only through confirmation

- whether the object can be versioned

- who may read, edit, approve, export, or delete it

2. Full state machine

The product logic now needs one explicit state machine. At the moment, readiness, review, and approval logic are conceptually defined but not yet expressed as a complete sequence of states and transitions.

A first implementation state model should likely include states such as:

- input_received
- parsed
- needs_review
- confirmed
- structure_approved
- cost_ready
- tender_ready
- released_for_tender

The state machine should define:

- allowed transitions
- blocking conditions
- which transitions are automatic
- which transitions require human approval
- which transitions create an audit event

3. Approval matrix

Approvals are already recognized as central, but the product still needs a precise approval matrix.

The approval matrix should define:

- which object types can require approval
- which role is allowed to approve each object
- whether approval is mandatory or optional
- what downstream step is unlocked after approval
- whether approval requires a simple click, a comment, or a signature

Examples that should be locked early include:

- approval of generated project structure
- approval of participant role assignments
- approval of cost estimate state
- release of tender package

4. Phase-based readiness rules

Readiness should now move from concept to rule set. It must become measurable and phase-dependent.

At minimum, the implementation should define rule sets for:

- structured project description readiness
- cost estimate readiness
- detailed planning readiness

- tender readiness

Each rule set should answer:

- which documents are required
- which approved resources are required
- which objects must exist
- which reviews must be complete
- which approvals must be complete

5. Role and permission matrix

The system already distinguishes between external sources, lightweight participants, and full users. What is still missing is the object-level permission matrix.

The permission matrix should define, by role and by object, who may:

- view
- upload
- comment
- edit
- approve
- assign
- export

This must cover at least these roles:

- Admin or Owner
- Architect or Project Lead
- Internal Team Member
- Vendor or Supplier
- Client
- External Source

This is especially important because the product needs different visibility rules, not only different rows. Some users will need restricted field-level visibility depending on role and project stage.

6. Provenance, confidence, and trust logic

The Trust UI concept is already agreed. It now needs to become a concrete product rule.

Every relevant object should visibly distinguish between:

- confirmed fact
- AI suggestion
- low-confidence assumption
- human approval required

The implementation should also preserve provenance data for each relevant object, including:

- source channel

- sender

- timestamp

- raw reference

- confidence score

- transformation history

This is critical for trust, review, dispute handling, and later auditability.

7. Search and query layer

The conversational interface is already part of the product, but its query behavior still needs to be locked as a system function.

The bot, search, and project query system should all operate on the same structured project model.

The implementation should support queries such as:

- what is missing before tender

- show unresolved review items

- which documents are still unassigned

- what changed since the last approved version

This means search is not a separate utility. It is a core interaction layer on top of project state.

8. Export and handover priorities

The product already recognizes that users must not feel trapped inside Tenderfish. The remaining step is to lock the export priority list for Phase 1.

The MVP should explicitly decide which exports are first priority, for example:

- project snapshot PDF

- structured project description export

- cost export to spreadsheet

- tender-relevant document package

- approval log

Later structured outputs such as GAEB or deeper integrations may follow, but the first export layer should be fixed now so the implementation can support trust and handover from the start.

9. Identity resolution and notification logic

Two additional system behaviors still need to be locked before implementation.

9.1 Identity resolution

The platform must reconcile repeated people, companies, and contributors across channels. This includes the same participant appearing through email, uploaded PDFs, forwarded messages, or later account creation.

9.2 Notifications and escalation

The platform needs lightweight but role-aware notifications. Phase 1 should at least define notification logic for:

- pending approvals

- missing input for readiness

- role confirmation requests

- blocked tender release

10. Final implementation note

At this point, the remaining work is no longer large-scale product ideation. It is the formalization of the system rules. Once these points are locked, the developers should have enough clarity to implement the MVP without ambiguity.

Short internal summary
The concept is largely complete. What remains open is the hard specification layer: object model, state machine, approval matrix, readiness rules, role permissions, trust logic, search behavior, export priorities, identity resolution, and notifications.